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Jaywan card starts rolling out across UAE

DUBAI
BY JUSTIN VARGHESE
Your Money Editor

Banks, financial institutions and licensed exchange houses across the UAE have started issuing Jaywan cards to customers, marking the nationwide rollout of the country's first national card scheme.

Sheikh Mansour Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Vice-President, Deputy Prime Minister, Chairman of the Presidential Court and Chairman of the Central Bank of the UAE, said the launch strengthened the country's sovereignty over its financial infrastructure.

"This achievement reflects the UAE's commitment to developing a more efficient, resilient and competitive financial sector that unlocks broader opportunities for innovation, promotes financial inclusion, and further strengthens the UAE's position as a leading global financial hub," he said.

Issued in phases

Cards will be issued in phases over the coming months. First Abu Dhabi Bank has launched a Jaywan debit card, Commercial Bank of Dubai is introducing prepaid cards, and Network International has enabled acceptance across thousands of UAE online merchants.

Jaywan cards support point-of-sale purchases, e-commerce transactions, ATM withdrawals, digital wallets and contactless payments. Cardholders will have access to partner offers covering travel, shopping, hospitality and lifestyle.

SEE ALSO P-1

New Prime Minister Burnham vows 10-year plan for Britain

FIFTY-SIX-YEAR-OLD LABOUR LEADER TO 'DO THINGS IN A DIFFERENT WAY'

LONDON

New UK Prime Minister Andy Burnham yesterday promised to set out a 10-year plan for Britain, to ease the cost of living crisis and outlined policy goals including an end to sleeping on the streets.

Accompanied by his wife Marie-France van Heel, Burnham earlier met King Charles III at Buckingham Palace to become the head of government after Keir Starmer resigned.

Burnham, 56, arrived at Downing Street to resounding applause from supporters and acknowledged he was the country's seventh prime minister since the start of 2016.

Britain needed to show the world it could "regain stability", he said, vowing to offer "a new political model" and "build a new economy".

In foreign policy goals, he told broadcasters earlier his first calls would be to US President Donald Trump and Ukrainian leader Volodymyr Zelensky, to whom he will offer reassurance that "I will be with him 100 per cent".

Setting goals

In his brief speech outside Downing Street, the new Labour leader said he would "bring forward a new plan for Britain, a 10-year plan", without giving specifics.

Naming short-term goals, he promised to "give people some breathing space now, some help with the cost of living."

He also said his first instruction would be a pledge to "end rough sleeping", a measure he attempted to implement as a regional mayor in northern England, although it was



AP

■ Britain's King Charles III welcomes Andy Burnham, left, at Buckingham Palace, London, where he invited the leader of the Labour Party to become Prime Minister and form a new government.

not fully successful. Other announcements included a pledge to reindustrialise Britain through public procurement and to build more public housing.

Burnham will face an in-tray overflowing with challenges with little time to make his mark with a nationwide election due in 2029.

In an interview with *The Times* published late Sunday, Burnham said he wanted to draw a line under a decade of political turmoil.

"What we've been doing hasn't been working. That's the way I see it," he said. "I am going to try and do things in a different way."

— AFP

SEE ALSO P10

UAE LEADERS CONGRATULATE NEW UK PM

President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan has congratulated Andy Burnham on becoming the United Kingdom's new Prime Minister.

In a post on X, Sheikh Mohamed wrote: "Congratulations to @andyburnham on becoming Prime Minister of the United Kingdom. I look forward to working together to further build upon the close and longstanding ties between our two countries and peoples."

His Highness Sheikh Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, also congratulated the new British Prime Minister.

In a post on X, Sheikh Mohammed said: "I congratulate Mr Andy Burnham on assuming the position of Prime Minister of the United Kingdom. We look forward to strengthening our strategic partnership, deepening economic cooperation, and further developing the exceptional historical ties that bind our two countries for the benefit and prosperity of our two friendly peoples."

—Gulf News Report

UAE condemns renewed Iranian attacks, pledges solidarity with Bahrain, Kuwait

Iranian President says his country is in a 'full-scale war' with the United States

DUBAI
Gulf News report

The UAE has condemned in the strongest terms the renewed hostile attacks by Iran targeting Bahrain and Kuwait with missiles and drones.

In a statement, the Ministry of Foreign Affairs (MoFA) affirmed that these hostile attacks constitute a flagrant violation of the sovereignty of the brotherly nations and a threat to their security and stability.

The Ministry reiterated the UAE's full solidarity with Bahrain and Kuwait, and its support for all measures aimed at safeguarding their security and stability.

The UAE's response came after warning sirens sounded across Kuwait yesterday after-



NAVCENT Public Affairs

■ The United States launched its ninth consecutive night of strikes on Iran on Sunday.

noon as the country's air defence systems intercepted what the military described as hostile missile and drone attacks linked to ongoing Iranian aggression.

Active response

In a statement, Kuwait's General Staff said its air defence systems actively responded to the incoming threats.

Bahrain's Ministry of Interior also activated alarm sirens and urged citizens and residents to remain calm and move to the nearest safe location.

Bahrain's civil aviation body said that Iran had targeted its air navigation systems with drones yesterday, though traffic remained unaffected.

Meanwhile, Yemen's Iran-backed Houthis rebels yesterday

announced a maritime embargo of Saudi Arabia, after the pair traded fire last week for the first time in years.

Vessel set alight

Sailors safely abandoned a vessel set alight after it was attacked in the Strait of Hormuz, the UK Maritime Trade Operations agency said yesterday, as the United States and Iran vie for control over the vital waterway.

Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian yesterday said his country was in a "full-scale war" with the United States and that Tehran should accept the repercussions of the conflict after the ninth consecutive day of US strikes.

Iran, however, said that diplomatic exchanges with the United States via mediators were ongoing despite the strikes. Iran's Interior Minister Eskandar Momeni is set to travel to mediator Pakistan's capital Islamabad, a Pakistani interior ministry source said.

SEE ALSO P6, 7, P-1V

Dubai's new driverless taxi is an effortless ride

Fasten your seatbelts and enjoy the drive

DUBAI
BY AREEBA HASHMI
Reporter



Apollo Go's autonomous fleet, now open to the public in Jumeirah and Umm Suqeim for a flat Dh5 a ride, is quite a unique experience.

The first thing to know is that Apollo Go has only launched at specific locations, and you cannot simply book a car to your doorstep.

Rides are booked through the Apollo Go app, and pickups and drop-offs are limited to designated bus stations within the service zone, so you will likely need to walk to the nearest one from wherever you actually are.

The app has its own walking navigation button built in to help with that. Once a car is booked, it does not wait around: it holds for about a minute, and if you have not boarded by then, the ride cancels

automatically, so it pays to get to your stop early rather than cutting it close.

Once you put your seatbelt on, only then does the car begin to move. It reads traffic lights well before it reaches them, easing off the accelerator the moment a green starts flashing so it rolls to a stop right as the light turns red, rather than braking hard at the last second or speeding to cross the light. U-turns are smooth and confident, and at one point, when a motorbike swerved unexpectedly nearby, the car sounded its horn on its own before you even knew what was happening.

SEE ALSO P4

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